

EVEN WITH ALL OF THE ADVANTAGES I HAD, SOME BIASES WERE JUST UNCONSCIOUS"

GAURI KIRLOSKAR
MANAGING DIRECTOR, KIRLOSKAR OIL ENGINES

- **Grew revenue grew 1.6 times, EBITDA 2.4 times and cash generated from operations 2.6 times between FY22 and FY25**
- **Led diversification into areas like internal combustion engines, energy storage, electrification, and fuel cells and electrolysers**
- **Strengthened positioning from an engine maker to an engineering and power solutions provider**
- **Leading a ₹5,000-crore investment towards doubling group turnover to $5 billion by 2030**

plicates the issue. Often, the patriarch wants to bring in his children—whether the son or daughter—at a higher position to give them a higher salary and perks that come with the role. This can backfire and cause resentment among senior managers, making it that much harder for the person to gain access and understand the inner workings of the organisation and establish themselves.

CHANGING ENVIRONMENT

Till the early 2000s, the family business landscape was dominated by companies in heavy manufacturing-led fields like auto components or industrial products. These continue to be male-dominated and seen as unsuitable for women.

An exception is Anjali Singh, Chairperson of automotive parts maker Gabriel India and the larger Anand Group of which it is a part. Singh joined the New Delhi-based group in 2005, and after working across various functions, joined the supervisory board in 2009, eventually taking over the top role from her father, Deep C. Anand, in 2011.

The challenges are different at each stage of the journey. "Mine was having to find acceptability of a different kind—having been a second generation, working with my father under someone's presence, then working with my father's CEO and then appointing my own CEO. These are different journeys. The challenge is having your own identity within the organisation whilst elders are still there," she says. Her advice is to uphold and keep the DNA of the company you inherited and still bring in your own unique elements.

Under her leadership, the Anand Group has diversified into newer areas, with a deep focus on technology and sustainability. This includes new launches under the flagship company Gabriel India, as well as a new plat-